

Rently — Database Schema Documentation

Living document — update this file as the project evolves.

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Overview

Rently is a housing rental portal built in Laravel. It supports three user types — Tenant, Property Manager, and Administrator — each with their own dashboard and permissions.

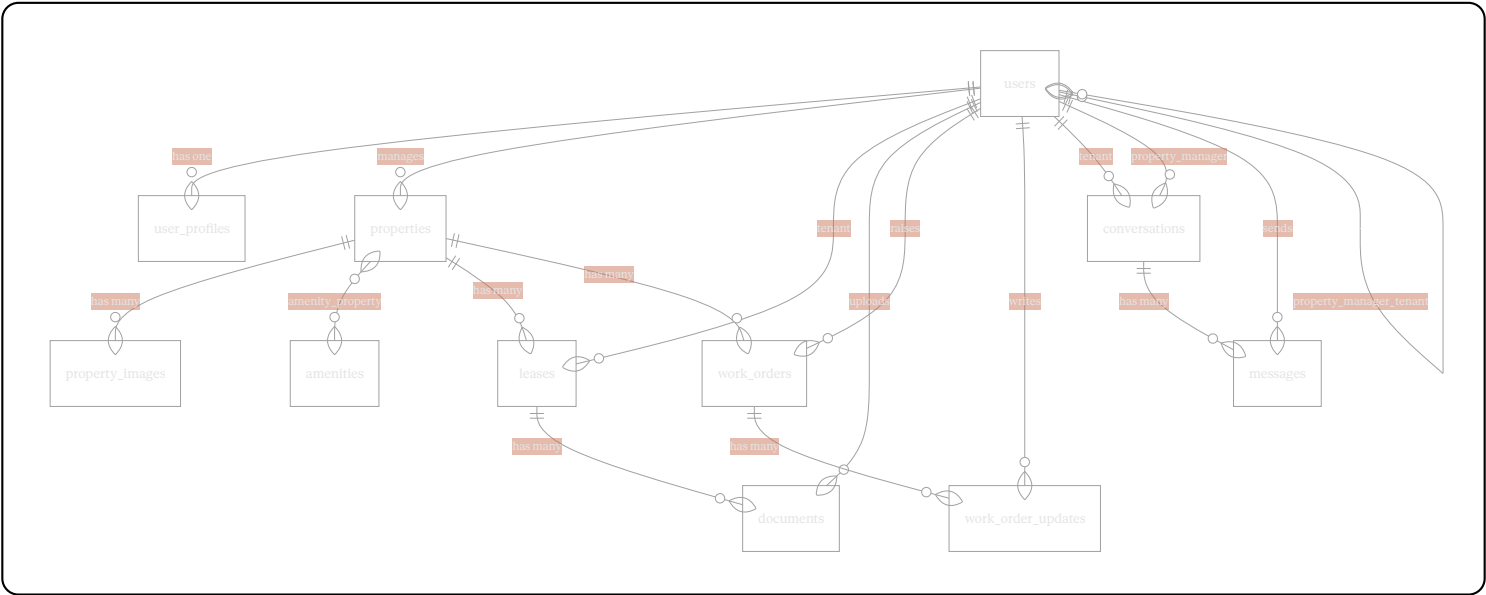
Tech stack

- Laravel 13 + Breeze (auth scaffolding)
- Spatie Laravel Permission (roles)
- MySQL

User Types

Role	Description
admin	Full system access. Manages users, properties, and assignments.
property_manager	Manages their assigned properties and tenants.
tenant	Access to their own lease, documents, messages, and work orders.

ERD Diagram



Tables

users

Scaffolded by Laravel Breeze. Extended with `first_name` and `last_name`.

Column	Type	Notes
id	bigint, PK	

first_name	string	
last_name	string	
email	string, unique	
email_verified_at	timestamp, nullable	
password	string	Hashed
remember_token	string, nullable	
created_at	timestamp	
updated_at	timestamp	

user_profiles

Extended profile data for all user types. Kept separate from `users` to keep the auth table lean.

Column	Type	Notes
id	bigint, PK	
user_id	FK → users	Cascades on delete
legal_name	string	
preferred_name	string, nullable	
phone	string, nullable	
address	string, nullable	Personal home address
emergency_contact_name	string, nullable	
emergency_contact_phone	string, nullable	
emergency_contact_relationship	string, nullable	e.g. spouse, parent, friend
profile_image	text, nullable	Storage path or URL
created_at	timestamp	
updated_at	timestamp	

roles (Spatie)

Managed by [Spatie Laravel Permission](#). Do not modify manually.

Seeded roles:

Name
admin
property_manager
tenant

Related Spatie tables: `permissions`, `model_has_roles`, `model_has_permissions`, `role_has_permissions`

properties

A property belongs to a property manager. Can be assigned to a tenant via a lease.

Column	Type	Notes
<code>id</code>	bigint, PK	
<code>property_manager_id</code>	FK → users, nullable	Cascades on delete
<code>title</code>	string	
<code>slug</code>	string, unique	SEO-friendly URL identifier
<code>key_features</code>	text, nullable	Free text / WYSIWYG input
<code>description</code>	longtext	
<code>address</code>	string	
<code>latitude</code>	decimal(10,7), nullable	
<code>longitude</code>	decimal(10,7), nullable	
<code>price</code>	decimal(10,2)	Monthly rent
	enum	

property_type		house, apartment, studio, commercial
bedrooms	tinyint unsigned	
bathrooms	tinyint unsigned	
size	integer, nullable	Square footage/metres — unit defined at app level
availability_status	enum	available, occupied, under_maintenance
created_at	timestamp	
updated_at	timestamp	

property_images

Stores images for a property. Supports featured image and ordering.

Column	Type	Notes
id	bigint, PK	
property_id	FK → properties	Cascades on delete
path	text	Storage path or URL
is_featured	boolean	Default: false
sort_order	integer	Default: 0
created_at	timestamp	
updated_at	timestamp	

amenities

A seeded lookup table of available amenities.

Column	Type	Notes
id	bigint, PK	

<code>name</code>	string	e.g. Parking, Garden
<code>slug</code>	string, unique	
<code>created_at</code>	timestamp	
<code>updated_at</code>	timestamp	

amenity_property

└ Pivot table — many-to-many between properties and amenities.

Column	Type	Notes
<code>property_id</code>	FK → properties	Cascades on delete
<code>amenity_id</code>	FK → amenities	Cascades on delete

Composite primary key: `(property_id, amenity_id)`

property_manager_tenant

└ Pivot table — links a property manager to their assigned tenants. Managed by admin.
Independent of leases so the assignment can exist before a lease is created.

Column	Type	Notes
<code>property_manager_id</code>	FK → users	Cascades on delete
<code>tenant_id</code>	FK → users	Cascades on delete
<code>created_at</code>	timestamp	
<code>updated_at</code>	timestamp	

Composite primary key: `(property_manager_id, tenant_id)`

leases

└ Links a tenant to a property for a defined period. Core record for tenancy management.

Column	Type	Notes
id	bigint, PK	
property_id	FK → properties	Restrict on delete — preserves lease history
tenant_id	FK → users	
status	enum	pending, active, ended, terminated
rent_amount	decimal(10,2)	
start_date	date	
end_date	date, nullable	
terminated_at	timestamp, nullable	
termination_notes	text, nullable	
created_at	timestamp	
updated_at	timestamp	

documents

Documents uploaded by a property manager for a tenant. Can optionally be tied to a lease. Supports simple signature flow.

Column	Type	Notes
id	bigint, PK	
uploaded_by	FK → users	Cascades on delete
tenant_id	FK → users	Cascades on delete
lease_id	FK → leases, nullable	Null on delete — important docs linked to lease
property_id	FK → properties, nullable	Context anchor when no lease exists
title	string	
path	text	Storage path or URL

document_type	string	e.g. tenancy_agreement, epc, welcome_pack. Consider enum once types are finalised
requires_signature	boolean	Default: false
is_signed	boolean	Default: false
signed_at	timestamp, nullable	
created_at	timestamp	
updated_at	timestamp	

Validation note: At least one of `lease_id` or `property_id` should be present. Enforce at app/validation layer.

work_orders

Maintenance/repair requests. Can be raised by either a tenant or property manager.

Column	Type	Notes
id	bigint, PK	
property_id	FK → properties	Restrict on delete — preserve history
lease_id	FK → leases, nullable	Null on delete
raised_by	FK → users	Cascades on delete
assigned_to	FK → users, nullable	Null on delete — property manager or contractor
title	string	
description	text	
priority	enum	low, medium, high, urgent
status	enum	open, in_progress, pending_review, resolved, closed
resolved_at	timestamp, nullable	

nullable

created_at	timestamp
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updated_at	timestamp
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work_order_updates

Log of comments and updates on a work order. Each entry tracks who posted it.

Column	Type	Notes
id	bigint, PK	
work_order_id	FK → work_orders	Cascades on delete
user_id	FK → users	Cascades on delete
comment	text	
created_at	timestamp	
updated_at	timestamp	

conversations

One conversation thread per tenant/property manager relationship. Not tied to a specific property or lease.

Column	Type	Notes
id	bigint, PK	
tenant_id	FK → users	Cascades on delete
property_manager_id	FK → users	Cascades on delete
last_message_at	timestamp, nullable	Used to sort inboxes by recent activity
created_at	timestamp	
updated_at	timestamp	

messages

Individual messages within a conversation. Supports system-generated messages.

Column	Type	Notes
id	bigint, PK	
conversation_id	FK → conversations	Cascades on delete
sender_id	FK → users	Cascades on delete
body	text	
is_system_message	boolean	Default: false. System messages cannot be replied to
read_at	timestamp, nullable	Null = unread
created_at	timestamp	
updated_at	timestamp	

notifications

Managed by Laravel's built-in notification system. Generated via:

```
bash
php artisan notifications:table
```

Column	Type	Notes
id	uuid, PK	
type	string	Notification class name
notifiable_type	string	Polymorphic — typically App\Models\User
notifiable_id	bigint	
data	text	JSON payload
read_at	timestamp, nullable	
created_at	timestamp	
updated_at	timestamp	

payments

🕒 **Deferred** — to be designed once core functionality is complete.

Planned links: `lease_id`, `tenant_id`, payment gateway reference, amount, status, due date.

Key Design Decisions

Decision	Reason
Single <code>users</code> table for all roles	Simpler auth flow. Roles managed by Spatie.
<code>property_manager_tenant</code> pivot independent of leases	Admin can assign a tenant to a manager before a lease exists.
<code>restrictOnDelete</code> on <code>property_id</code> in leases	Prevents accidental deletion of a property with active/historical leases.
<code>tenant_id</code> uses <code>constrained('users')</code> explicitly	Laravel cannot infer the <code>users</code> table from a non-standard column name.
<code>last_message_at</code> on conversations	Avoids expensive subqueries when sorting inboxes.
<code>is_system_message</code> on messages	Allows UI to style and disable replies on automated messages (e.g. work order updates).
<code>read_at</code> timestamp instead of boolean	Gives read time for free, not just read state.
<code>document_type</code> as string (not enum yet)	Types not fully defined yet — convert to enum once finalised.
Laravel built-in notifications table	Integrates with <code>Notifiable</code> trait, supports multiple channels out of the box.
Spatie Laravel Permission for roles	Battle-tested, widely supported, clean API (<code>assignRole</code> , <code>hasRole</code>).